Surveys

1 After the government decided to increase the minimum retirement age, a news poll selected a group of people to ask their opinions on the changes.

Determine whether the following people should be represented to avoid sampling bias.

a People in the community who have a wide variety of views, excluding politicians and policy makers.

b People in the community who have a wide variety of views, even if they are not directly affected by the changes.

c Only people in the community who would be directly affected by the changes.

2 A radio station conducts a poll asking its listeners to call in to say if they are for or against restrictions on scalpers selling tickets for gigs at a higher price.

Determine whether the following are the reasons why this is not an appropriate way to conduct a poll.

a A large variety of people are likely to call.

b A person can call more than once, so they could be counted more than once.

c People with stronger views are more likely to call than those who don't have a strong view.

3 A question is inappropriate for a survey given it fulfills any of the following criteria:

- Question is unclear
- Emotional language
- Should be a "yes" or "no" question
- Question is too personal

Using the criteria list, determine why each of the questions are inappropriate.

a How many large electronic devices are in your home?

b Many people have worked incredibly hard and even died making this bridge. Do you like the bridge?

c What is your favourite breed of dog?

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4 Determine whether the following questions are likely to give biased results or not:

a Yvonne is asking people on her soccer team, "What's your favourite sport?"

b Lachlan randomly selected people from his school to find about the school sports. He asked "What's your favourite school sport?"

c Tricia randomly selected people from her school and asked, "The local AFL team is donating money to our school this term. What's your favourite sport?"

d Lulu is interviewing people outside of a train station. She asks "Should the government spend more money on public transportation?"

e Shadie is interviewing people about how shark nets are affecting shark attack numbers. He asks "Shark nets cost $\$1\,000\,000$ per year and barely help. Do you support shark nets?"

5 Write a possible question you could ask in order to find out the following information:

a You want to gather information about how many people have had a dog as a pet.

b You're interviewing students to find out how often they read.

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